

Meet the expert

Dr. Beccy Scott works at the British Museum in London, England. She is particularly interested in Neanderthals and is trying to find out how they survived in the area around the English Channel by studying their stone tools in detail.



Q: Could you explain what an archaeologist does?

A: Archaeologists use the traces (pieces) people leave behind to recreate what their lives were like. We might excavate (dig) the sites where they lived and recover objects that they left behind: stone tools, pottery, animal bones. We then study these things in detail—to see how they were made, and what they were used for.

Q: What inspired you to become an archaeologist?

A: I grew up near the chalk hills of Kent, England, so I was always collecting flints, trying to make arrowheads, and trying to find monuments marked on maps.

Q: What do you enjoy most about being an archaeologist?

A: I enjoy fieldwork the best. When you're digging, it brings you close to the people we're studying. You're recreating the actions of someone thousands of years ago. It can feel a bit spooky!

Q: What do you love about studying the Stone Age in particular?

A: I love that we only have evidence that Stone Age people left us to understand how they lived. It means you need a good imagination to open your mind to all possibilities!



Chalk cliffs on the coast of Kent, England, where Beccy grew up



Beccy enjoyed trying to make arrowheads as a child.